CALENDAR OF EVENTS 2026

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Comprehensive Calendar of Minangkabau Cultural Festivals, Traditional Arts & Kharisma Event Nusantara in West Sumatra (January - December 2026).



26	8
TOTAL EVENTS	KARISMA EVENTS (KEN)

GEOGRAPHIC INFOGRAPHIC

19 REGENCIES & CITIES

WEST SUMATRA EVENT DISTRIBUTION MAP

Distribution of cultural festivals & traditional attractions across 4 regions in West Sumatra.

1. HIGHLANDS & LUHAK NAN TUO

5 KEN

- **Tanah Datar:** Pacu Jawi (KEN), Festival Pesona Minangkabau (KEN)
- **Agam & Bukittinggi:** Festival Rakik-Rakik, Pesona Maninjau, Pacu Kudo
- **Limapuluh Kota & Payakumbuh:** Payakumbuh Botuang (KEN), Pasa Harau (KEN), Alek Bakajang (KEN)

2. WEST COAST & MARINE

3 KEN

- **Padang City:** Festival Siti Nurbaya (KEN), Festival Muaro Padang, Cap Go Meh
- **Pariaman & Padang Pariaman:** Festival Tabuik (KEN), Pesona Nyarai
- **South Pesisir:** Festival Langkisau & Paragliding Championship
- **Mentawai Islands:** Festival Pesona Mentawai (KEN)

3. LAKES & GEOPARK HERITAGE

2 KEN

- **Solok City & Regency:** Rang Solok Baralek Gadang (KEN), 5 Lakes Festival
- **Sawahlunto City:** SISCA (KEN), SIMFes (UNESCO World Heritage)
- **Cross-Region:** Tour de Singkarak (TdS) World Cycling Championship

4. BORDERLANDS & ANCIENT HISTORY

MURI Record

- **West Pasaman:** Maapam Pasaman Traditional Festival (MURI Record)
- **Dharmasraya:** Pamalayu Cultural Festival (Padang Roco Temple Complex)

FESTIVAL AGENDA 2026 (JAN - DEC)

Summary of official cultural festivals & attractions across 19 Regencies/Cities.

01 Pacu Jawi (Traditional Mud Bull Race) — Page 1

Every Weekend (Saturday & Sunday on Rotating Nagari Post-Harvest)

Tanah Datar Rice Fields (Sungai Tarab, Pariangan, Rambatan)

02 Pamalayu Historical Heritage Festival — Page 2

January 6 – 10, 2026 (Dharmasraya Anniversary)

Padang Roco Temple Complex & Batanghari River, Dharmasraya

03 Pasaman Maapam Heritage Culinary Festival — Page 3

Rajab 1447 H (Commemorating Isra Mi'raj)

Nagari Kapa & Simpang Empat, West Pasaman Regency

04 Minang Traditional Horse Racing Cup — Page 4

February, June, and October (Rotating Across Race Tracks)

Bukit Ambacang (Bukittinggi) & Kubu Gadang (Payakumbuh) Racecourses

05 Alek Bakajang Cultural Heritage (KEN) — Page 5

March 24 – 28, 2026 (Completed)

Batang Maek River, Gunuang Malintang, Lima Puluh Kota Regency

06 Langkisau Beach & Paragliding Festival — Page 6

April 16 – 22, 2026 (Pesisir Selatan Anniversary)

Carocok Beach & Langkisau Hill, Painan, Pesisir Selatan

07 Muaro Padang Waterfront & Heritage Festival — Page 7

April 18 – 24, 2026 (Eid Holiday Season)

Padang Old Town & Batang Arau Riverfront, Padang City

FESTIVAL AGENDA 2026 (JAN - DEC)

Summary of official cultural festivals & attractions across 19 Regencies/Cities.

08 **Hoyak Tabuik Cultural Festival (KEN)** KEN 2026 — Page 8
June 16 – 28, 2026 (Peak 10 Muharram 1448 H)
Pariaman City & Gandoriah Beach

09 **Festival Pesona Minangkabau (KEN)** KEN 2026 — Page 9
June 25 – 27, 2026 (Completed)
Istano Basa Pagaruyung, Batusangkar, Tanah Datar

10 **Maninjau Rakik-Rakik Floating Festival (KEN)** — Page 10
Eid al-Fitr Eve & June 28 – 30, 2026
Lake Maninjau Shores, Agam Regency

11 **Sawahlunto Int. Music Festival / SIMFes (KEN)** KEN 2026 — Page 11
July 17 – 18, 2026
UNESCO Ombilin World Heritage Site, Sawahlunto

12 **Pacu Itiak (Traditional Flying Duck Race)** — Page 12
Every Weekend (July - November 2026)
Payakumbuh & Lima Puluh Kota Regency

13 **Payakumbuh Botuang Festival** — Page 13
July / August 2026 (Schedule To Be Confirmed)
Ampangan, Payakumbuh City

14 **Siti Nurbaya Cultural Festival (KEN)** KEN 2026 — Page 14
August 4 – 7, 2026 (Padang City Anniversary)
Padang Old Town, Muaro Padang & Gunung Padang

FESTIVAL AGENDA 2026 (JAN - DEC)

Summary of official cultural festivals & attractions across 19 Regencies/Cities.

15 **Pasa Harau Art & Culture Festival (KEN)** Page 15

August 28 – 30, 2026 • Harau Valley Geopark Area, Lima Puluh Kota Regency

16 **Danau Maninjau & Kelok 44 Scenic Festival** Page 16

August 14 – 18, 2026 • Lake Maninjau & Puncak Lawang, Agam Regency

17 **Lake Singkarak Heritage & Cultural Festival** Page 17

August 2026 • Lake Singkarak Waterfront, Solok & Tanah Datar

18 **Rang Solok Baralek Gadang Festival (KEN)** KEN 2026 Page 18

September 2026 (Exact Dates To Be Confirmed) • Solok Rice Fields, Solok City

19 **Sawahlunto Int. Songket Silungkang Carnival (KEN)** Page 19

KEN 2026

September 4 – 6, 2026 • Sawahlunto World Heritage City

20 **Grand Minangkabau Marandang & Culinary Festival** Page 20

September 2026 • Jam Gadang Plaza Bukittinggi & Padang

21 **Tour de Singkarak (International Cycling Tour)** Page 21

On Hiatus / Postponed (Planned Return in 2027) • Across West Sumatra Regencies & Cities

FESTIVAL AGENDA 2026 (JAN - DEC)

Summary of official cultural festivals & attractions across 19 Regencies/Cities.

22 **Serak Gulo Padang Heritage Festival** Page 22

Jumada al-Thani 1448 H / Late 2026 • Muhammadan Mosque, Padang City

23 **Solok 5 Lakes Ecotourism Festival (KEN)** KEN 2026 Page 23

October 29 – 31, 2026 • Solok Regency (5 Lakes: Singkarak, Diatas, Dibawah, Talang, Tuo)

24 **Pesona Mentawai Indigenous Festival (KEN)** KEN 2026 Page 24

October 1 – 3, 2026 • Mentawai Islands (Siberut & Tuapejat)

25 **Air Bangis Coastal & Marine Festival** Page 25

October 2026 • Air Bangis Port Bay, West Pasaman Regency

26 **Batang Arau Heritage & Padang Waterfront Festival** Page 26

November 2026 • Old Town & Batang Arau Estuary, Padang City



EVERY WEEKEND (SATURDAY & SUNDAY ON ROTATING NAGARI POST-HARVEST)

Pacu Jawi (Traditional Mud Bull Race)

📅 **Every Weekend (Saturday & Sunday on Rotating Nagari Post-Harvest)**

📍 **Tanah Datar Rice Fields (Sungai Tarab, Pariangan, Rambatan)**

Pacu Jawi is a legendary Minangkabau cultural tradition celebrated for centuries across Tanah Datar Regency, notably in the historic sub-districts of Pariangan, Rambatan, Lima Kaum, and Sungai Tarab. Originating as a festive post-harvest thanksgiving ritual, it also serves as an arena for local farmers to showcase the agility, speed, and health of their prized working cattle.

The signature thrill of Pacu Jawi lies in the daring jockey balancing bare-foot on a wooden plow frame while gripping the tails of a pair of charging bulls sprinting across deep, wet mud. Jockeys often bite the bulls' tails to urge maximum speed; the pair that runs the straightest and fastest commands the highest prestige and significantly increases the bull's market value.

Rotating weekly across rural villages after each rice harvest, Pacu Jawi has evolved into a world-class tourism spectacle and a mecca for international photographers seeking dramatic mud-splashing action shots. The festive atmosphere is amplified by the rhythmic clanging of traditional talempong music and authentic countryside delicacies served along the paddy ridges.



January 6 – 10, 2026 (Dharmasraya Anniversary)

Padang Roco Temple Complex & Batanghari River, Dharmasraya

Pamalayu Historical Heritage Festival is a monumental archaeological and cultural commemoration held in Dharmasraya Regency, reviving the golden era of the 13th-century Malayu Dharmasraya Kingdom (Swarnabhumi). Centered around the ancient brick sanctuaries of Padang Roco Temple and the Batanghari River, it commemorates the historic Pamalayu Expedition and ancient Nusantara diplomatic alliances.

The festival program features a ceremonial historical boat flotilla along the great Batanghari River, exhibitions of rare archaeological treasures including replicas of the sacred Amoghapasa statue and Padang Roco inscriptions, international Malay cultural symposiums, traditional dance festivals, and youth heritage camps.

The event provides profound historical education, illuminating ancient Sumatran riverine civilization for researchers, youth, and global travelers. Set within the tranquil grounds of Padang Roco Temple, visitors can immerse themselves in ancient history while admiring indigenous Dharmasraya natural-clay batik textiles (batik tanah liek).



RAJAB 1447 H (COMMEMORATING ISRA MI'RAJ)

Pasaman Maapam Heritage Culinary Festival

Rajab 1447 H (Commemorating Isra Mi'raj)

Nagari Kapa & Simpang Empat, West Pasaman Regency

Pasaman Maapam Heritage Culinary Festival is a proud communal culinary tradition celebrated across Pasaman and West Pasaman Regencies. Held annually during the holy month of Rajab in the Islamic calendar to commemorate the ascension of Isra Mi'raj, this mass apam cooking ritual has been handed down through generations as an act of charity, gratitude, and spiritual purification.

Thousands of village women (Bundo Kanduang) assemble in open town squares to cook traditional apam cakes simultaneously over hundreds of earthenware cauldrons and crackling firewood stoves. The delicate rice-flour batter is slow-steamed over fresh banana leaves, producing soft, fragrant cakes served with rich, warm palm-sugar coconut milk syrup.

The festival holds an official record in the Indonesian World Records Museum (MURI) for the largest simultaneous mass apam gathering in the nation. The central essence of the tradition lies in strengthening inter-village kinship, celebrating communal solidarity, and preserving Pasaman's timeless gastronomic heritage for future generations.



FEBRUARY, JUNE, AND OCTOBER (ROTATING ACROSS RACE TRACKS)

Minang Traditional Horse Racing Cup

📅 **February, June, and October (Rotating Across Race Tracks)**

📍 **Bukit Ambacang (Bukittinggi) & Kubu Gadang (Payakumbuh) Racecourses**

Minang Traditional Horse Racing Cup (Pacu Kudo) is a prestigious equestrian heritage sport deeply ingrained in the cultural identity of the Minangkabau highlands for over a century since the 1880s. Staged rotationally throughout the year at historic racetracks including Bukit Ambacang in Bukittinggi, Kubu Gadang in Payakumbuh, and Kandi in Sawahlunto.

The most thrilling and daring hallmark of Pacu Kudo is the remarkable skill of young traditional jockeys who ride powerful racehorses completely bareback without saddles at breakneck speeds. The roar of tens of thousands of spectators packing natural hillside viewing banks merges with thunderous hoofbeats and rising dust, generating an electrifying folk festival atmosphere.

Pacu Kudo is more than a sport; it is an arena of inter-village pride and prestige that drives local equestrian breeding and care. Surrounding the tracks, lively traditional markets offer iconic local delicacies such as Katupek Pitalah, Sate Danguang-Danguang, and authentic artisanal souvenirs.



MARCH 24 – 28, 2026 (COMPLETED)

Alek Bakajang Cultural Heritage (KEN)

March 24 – 28, 2026 (Completed)

Batang Maek River, Gunuang Malintang, Lima Puluh Kota Regency

Alek Bakajang is a distinct riverine heritage festival officially designated as an Indonesian National Intangible Cultural Heritage (WBTb) and celebrated under the Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) banner. Held annually from the 3rd to 7th of Shawwal following Eid al-Fitr in Nagari Gunuang Malintang, Lima Puluh Kota Regency, it serves as a sacred embodiment of kinship and solidarity among the village's five customary clans.

The centerpiece of the festival is the ceremonial voyage of intricately decorated kajang riverboats, beautifully crafted into floating replicas of traditional Rumah Gadang palaces and majestic vessels adorned with colorful Minang motifs. Each decorated vessel represents a customary clan pillar navigating along the clear waters of the Batang Maek River to conduct formal kinship visitations with clan chiefs.

Thousands of returning diaspora and local villagers gather along the lush riverbanks to celebrate the passing boat flotilla amidst lively talempong melodies, improvised poetry, and celebratory fireworks. Alek Bakajang stands as a living testament to communal unity and ancestral bonds preserved faithfully across generations.



APRIL 16 – 22, 2026 (PESISIR SELATAN ANNIVERSARY)

Langkisau Beach & Paragliding Festival

📅 April 16 – 22, 2026 (Pesisir Selatan Anniversary)

📍 Carocok Beach & Langkisau Hill, Painan, Pesisir Selatan

Langkisau Coastal & Sports Festival is the premier marine tourism and aerosport event in western Sumatra, held annually every April to celebrate the founding anniversary of Pesisir Selatan Regency. Centered around Carocok Beach in Painan and the summit of Bukit Langkisau, the festival seamlessly blends breathtaking tropical sea landscapes with vibrant cultural festivities and extreme sports.

The crown jewel of the event is the national and international paragliding and hang-gliding championship, where pilots launch from the 400-meter crest of Langkisau Hill to glide over azure waters and land on Salido Beach against a 360-degree panorama of Painan Bay. Coastal waters come alive with traditional wooden boat races, beach volleyball cups, and illuminated flotilla parades.

Travelers can savor delectable fresh seafood feasts including Sate Lokan clam skewers and rich fish curries, enjoy sunset concerts at Carocok Beach, and take a floating bridge across to Cingkuak Island to explore the atmospheric ruins of 17th-century Portuguese and Dutch VOC fortifications.



APRIL 18 – 24, 2026 (EID HOLIDAY SEASON)

Muaro Padang Waterfront & Heritage Festival

📅 April 18 – 24, 2026 (Eid Holiday Season)

📍 Padang Old Town & Batang Arau Riverfront, Padang City

Festival Muaro Padang is a vibrant waterfront and urban heritage carnival celebrated along the scenic Batang Arau river corridor and Siti Nurbaya Bridge in Padang City. Organized during the festive Eid holiday season, the event commemorates the maritime legacy and historical charm of West Sumatra's oldest trading port and colonial riverfront.

A dynamic array of attractions draws tens of thousands of visitors, featuring competitive dragon boat regattas (selaju sampan), an illuminated evening flotilla parade along the river, vintage street-food bazaars serving nostalgic Padang delicacies, and open-air jazz and ethnic acoustic stages beside the water.

The revitalized Batang Arau promenade, with its pedestrian-friendly walkways and artistic architectural lighting, allows tourists to take leisurely evening strolls admiring 19th-century colonial trading houses. Festival Muaro Padang successfully revitalizes the historical port into a safe, lively, and family-friendly evening tourism destination.



JUNE 16 – 28, 2026 (PEAK 10 MUHARRAM 1448 H)

Hoyak Tabuik Cultural Festival (KEN)

📅 June 16 – 28, 2026 (Peak 10 Muharram 1448 H)

📍 Pariaman City & Gandoriah Beach

Hoyak Tabuik Cultural Festival is one of the oldest and most colossal coastal heritage spectacles in Western Sumatra, held annually from the 1st to the 10th of Muharram in Pariaman City. Rooted in traditions dating back to the early 19th century, this iconic festival is officially recognized in the prestigious Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) calendar by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy.

The ten-day ritual sequence unfolds through a series of sacred symbolic stages: Maambiak Tanah (gathering sacred soil), Manabang Batang Pisang (cleaving the banana stalk), Maatam, and Maarak Saroban. The monumental climax features two towering 12-meter effigies—Tabuik Pasa and Tabuik Subarang—paraded, danced, and energetically hoisted (dihoyak) by tens of thousands of participants to the thunderous, hypnotic beats of gandang tasa drums.

At dusk on Gandoriah Beach, both massive Tabuik towers are carried into the crashing waves of the Indian Ocean and cast into the sea against a fiery sunset, symbolizing spiritual catharsis and communal renewal for the Islamic New Year. The awe-inspiring maritime ritual stands as an internationally renowned cultural tourism landmark.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



📅 June 25 – 27, 2026 (Completed)

📍 Istano Basa Pagaruyung, Batusangkar, Tanah Datar

Festival Pesona Minangkabau is the crowning cultural extravaganza in West Sumatra, staged against the majestic historical backdrop of Istano Basa Pagaruyung Palace in Tanah Datar Regency. As a flagship event within the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) calendar, it serves as the ultimate showcase representing the full spectrum of Minangkabau customs, performing arts, and philosophical values.

The grand festival features awe-inspiring spectacles including a grand cultural parade of thousands of Bundo Kanduang matriarchs in regal traditional attire from all 19 cities and regencies, MURI record-breaking Makan Bajamba communal feasts, plate-dancing feats over shattered glass, ancient silek tuo martial arts exhibitions, and classical orchestral performances.

Visitors can engage directly with traditional clan elders, admire historical artifact exhibitions from the ancient Minangkabau kingdom, and savor rare heirloom culinary recipes. Framed by the three-tiered gonjong roofs of Pagaruyung Palace, this festival delivers an immersive cultural journey of unmatched authenticity.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



EID AL-FITR EVE & JUNE 28 – 30, 2026

Maninjau Rakik-Rakik Floating Festival (KEN)

📅 Eid al-Fitr Eve & June 28 – 30, 2026

📍 Lake Maninjau Shores, Agam Regency

Rakik-Rakik Floating Festival is a sacred lacustrine heritage tradition cherished for generations across the villages surrounding Lake Maninjau in Agam Regency. Celebrated on the eve of Eid al-Fitr (1st of Shawwal) and during the holiday season, this vibrant festival expresses the communal joy and spiritual triumph of the villagers following the holy month of Ramadan.

Each lakeside nagari unites to construct massive floating bamboo rafts (rakik), elaborately sculpted into illuminated miniatures of traditional Rumah Gadang palaces, multi-tiered mosques, or ancient royal barges adorned with hundreds of oil torches. Floating across the lake waters, villagers ignite traditional carbide bamboo cannons, producing thunderous booming echoes that reverberate against the towering volcanic caldera walls.

The magical glow of hundreds of floating lanterns reflected upon the tranquil lake surface, paired with fireworks and celebratory cannonades, creates an unforgettable photographic spectacle. Visitors can enjoy this enchanting night from lakeside piers while savoring warm cups of Kawa Daun coffee-leaf tea and authentic grilled Palai Rinuak fish.



JULY 17 – 18, 2026

Sawahlunto Int. Music Festival / SIMFes (KEN)

📅 July 17 – 18, 2026

📍 UNESCO Ombilin World Heritage Site, Sawahlunto

Sawahlunto International Music Festival (SIMFes) is a world-class ethnic and contemporary world music festival held in the historic city of Sawahlunto, West Sumatra. Curated within the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) roster, SIMFes fosters a vibrant cross-continental musical dialogue bringing together celebrated international artists with master composers of Minangkabau and Indonesian traditional arts.

The defining highlight of SIMFes is its atmospheric concert stages set within the preserved industrial heritage architecture of the UNESCO-listed Ombilin coal mining complex, including the Gudang Ransum Museum, Coal Silos, and Segitiga Square. The haunting melodies of saluang bamboo flutes and rhythmic talempong gongs blend seamlessly with world jazz, African percussion, and classical orchestrations.

Beyond nightly outdoor concerts, SIMFes hosts interactive world music workshops, masterclasses for young talents, and spontaneous jam sessions in vintage old-town cafes. The sublime fusion of acoustic virtuosity and 19th-century colonial charm establishes SIMFes as one of Southeast Asia's most distinctive music festivals.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



EVERY WEEKEND (JULY – NOVEMBER 2026)

Pacu Itiak (Traditional Flying Duck Race)

📅 Every Weekend (July – November 2026)

📍 Payakumbuh & Lima Puluh Kota Regency

Pacu Itiak (Flying Duck Race) is an extraordinary traditional sporting pageant with no parallel anywhere else on the globe, held exclusively in Payakumbuh City and Lima Puluh Kota Regency. Originating in the early 20th century, the spectacle arose from astute village duck herders who discovered that native female ducks possessed the rare aeronautical capability of soaring long distances across rice field basins.

During a Pacu Itiak tournament, highly conditioned ducks are launched into the air by their jockeys at the starting post, gracefully flapping their wings to fly distances ranging from 800 to 2,000 meters toward the designated finish boundary. Referees positioned along the open-air course judge flight velocity, trajectory straightness, and precision landing within marked finishing quadrants without touching the ground prematurely.

The tournament grounds are charged with festive camaraderie, cheered on by thousands of enthusiastic spectators, roaring Gandang Tambua percussion, and buzzing village night food markets. Pacu Itiak is officially recognized as an Indonesian National Intangible Cultural Heritage and a premier international tourism draw.



July / August 2026 (Schedule To Be Confirmed)

Ampangan, Payakumbuh City

Payakumbuh Botuang Festival is an innovative arts and ecological celebration that explores the multifaceted significance of botuang (bamboo) in the cultural fabric of the Luak Limopuluah region. Staged amidst the verdant highlands of Panorama Ampangan, the festival bridges ancient Minangkabau heritage with eco-conscious contemporary artistic expression.

Master musicians, artisans, architects, and choreographers from across the nation gather to craft monumental bamboo sculptures, perform on rare ethnic bamboo instruments such as talempong botuang and sampelong flutes, and present immersive open-air nature theatricals. Visitors are also treated to traditional lamang tapai and authentic dishes slow-cooked inside freshly harvested bamboo tubes.

The festival serves as an invaluable platform for environmental education, highlighting bamboo conservation and its vast potential for rural community empowerment. As night falls, artistic illuminations cast a warm glow over massive bamboo installations against the crisp mountain air, offering an enchanting visual and acoustic sanctuary.



AUGUST 4 – 7, 2026 (PADANG CITY ANNIVERSARY)

Siti Nurbaya Cultural Festival (KEN)

📅 August 4 – 7, 2026 (Padang City Anniversary)

📍 Padang Old Town, Muaro Padang & Gunung Padang

Siti Nurbaya Cultural Festival is a coastal arts, heritage, and literary celebration held annually to commemorate the founding anniversary of Padang City. Inspired by Marah Rusli's timeless Minangkabau literary masterpiece, this Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) festival unfolds across historic landmarks including Padang Old Town, Siti Nurbaya Bridge, and the Batang Arau riverfront.

The festival lineup features grand musical theatrical reenactments of the Siti Nurbaya romance, an elaborate parade of thousands wearing traditional Baju Kuruang Basiba attire, mass rendang cooking competitions (marandang), traditional riverboat regattas, and multicultural parades showcasing peaceful coexistence among Minang, Chinese, Nias, and Javanese communities.

The event offers travelers a wonderful opportunity to wander through vintage colonial heritage quarters, hike up Mount Padang to visit the legendary Siti Nurbaya vantage point at sunset, and indulge in iconic culinary delicacies along the bustling Padang waterfront promenade.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



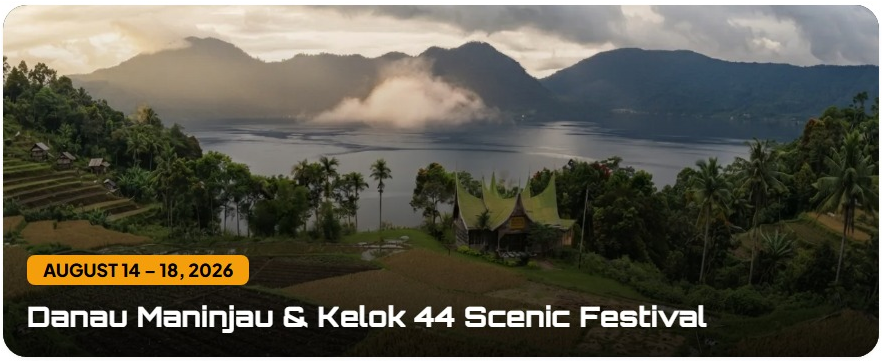
📅 August 28 – 30, 2026

📍 Harau Valley Geopark Area, Lima Puluh Kota Regency

Pasa Harau Art & Culture Festival is an enchanting eco-arts and cultural celebration hosted within the dramatic granite wonderland of Harau Valley in Lima Puluh Kota Regency. Featured in the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) calendar, the festival transforms the sheer 300-meter monolithic canyon walls into a majestic natural open-air amphitheater.

The festival showcases a captivating artistic dialogue between traditional Minangkabau masters and contemporary artists from across Indonesia and abroad. Highlights include colossal Randai folk-theatre performances below the cliffs, nighttime acoustic ethnic concerts under starlit skies, eco-campsites, cultural village processions, and environmental visual arts workshops.

At the heart of the grounds, the bustling 'Pasa Harau' village bazaar offers organic produce from local farmers, authentic heritage culinary delicacies, and woven handicrafts. Savoring evocative acoustic melodies accompanied by the rustle of tropical rainforests and distant waterfalls makes Pasa Harau a dream destination for art and nature enthusiasts.



AUGUST 14 – 18, 2026

Danau Maninjau & Kelok 44 Scenic Festival

August 14 – 18, 2026

Lake Maninjau & Puncak Lawang, Agam Regency

Danau Maninjau & Kelok 44 Scenic Festival is an integrated tourism celebration fusing the geological grandeur of Lake Maninjau's ancient volcanic caldera with the thrilling challenge of the legendary 44 hairpin mountain curves (Kelok 44) in Agam Regency. The festival showcases highland sport tourism, traditional lakeside arts, and ecological conservation.

Key attractions include the grueling Kelok 44 uphill mountain race challenging runners through misty highland switchbacks, paragliding competitions launching from the panoramic ridge of Puncak Lawang to land beside the water, illuminated lake flotillas, and floating concert stages featuring traditional Saluang flutes and energetic Tambua Tasa drumming.

Visitors are treated to breathtaking 360-degree vistas of the crater lake from Puncak Lawang, cultural tours to the historic birthplace of renowned scholar and novelist Buya Hamka in Sungai Batang, and authentic culinary tastings of crisp endemic Rinuak fish and savory Bada Masiak dishes.



AUGUST 2026

Lake Singkarak Heritage & Cultural Festival

August 2026 | Lake Singkarak Waterfront, Solok & Tanah Datar

The Lake Singkarak Heritage Festival is a premier annual cultural and watersports celebration held along the shores of West Sumatra's second largest tectonic lake, spanning both Solok and Tanah Datar Regencies. The festival celebrates the indigenous lake basin heritage, champions the conservation of endemic bilih fish (Mystacoleucus padangensis), and elevates Singkarak's geopark wonders on the global tourism map.

The festival lineup features colorful flotillas of traditional wooden dragon boats adorned in Minang Rumah Gadang motifs, open-water swimming marathons, artisan songket textile showcases, and colossal open-air performances of Tari Piring plate dances and Silek martial arts on floating waterfront stages. Crowds gather to soak in the resonant chimes of Talempong gongs carried on refreshing mountain breezes.

Beyond performing arts, the festival hosts an expansive gastronomy fair celebrating fried crispy bilih fish, rich pangek stews, and fragrant Bareh Solok rice. The Lake Singkarak Festival represents a golden opportunity to experience the seamless harmony between majestic geology and living communal culture.



SEPTEMBER 2026 (EXACT DATES TO BE CONFIRMED)

Rang Solok Baralek Gadang Festival (KEN)

📅 September 2026 (Exact Dates To Be Confirmed)

📍 Solok Rice Fields, Solok City

Rang Solok Baralek Gadang Festival is a grand agrarian cultural celebration honoring the legendary Solok Rice (Bareh Solok) as one of the archipelago's finest heritage grains and a cultural cornerstone of Minangkabau society. Selected for the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) roster, the festival takes place directly within the sprawling organic paddy fields of Hamparan Sawah Solok facing Mount Talang.

A rich variety of ancestral ceremonies and lively folk games take center stage in the muddy fields, including the sacred Batulak Bala blessing rite, ceremonial jamba food tray processions by hundreds of Bundo Kanduang elders, upiah palm leaf racing, and mud martial arts (silek lumpur). The spirit of communal solidarity culminates in a massive open-air Makan Bajamba communal banquet on the field dykes.

Beyond celebrating agricultural bounty, the festival actively educates visitors on food sovereignty, sustainable organic farming practices, and centuries-old traditional irrigation wisdom. The breathtaking visual panorama of golden paddy fields makes it a premier destination for cultural and eco-tourism enthusiasts alike.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



📅 September 4 – 6, 2026 | 📍 Sawahlunto World Heritage City

Sawahlunto International Songket Silungkang Carnival (SISSCa) is an internationally acclaimed street couture and heritage textile festival held in the historic mining city of Sawahlunto, a designated UNESCO World Heritage site. Consistently curated within the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) program, SISSCa serves as a premier global platform for celebrating and preserving authentic Silungkang Songket weaves.

Throughout the festival, the cobblestone streets and Dutch colonial avenues of the old town transform into the longest open-air runway in West Sumatra. Hundreds of visionary designers from across Indonesia and abroad showcase breathtaking avant-garde carnival costumes that integrate intricate gold-threaded Songket motifs with modern artistic creativity.

Complementing the grand street parade, SISSCa features live artisan weaving demonstrations, heritage fashion symposiums, old-town culinary fairs, and guided tours of historic coal-mining sites like Lubang Mbah Soero. The captivating juxtaposition of 19th-century European industrial architecture and glittering heritage textiles delivers an unforgettable travel experience.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



SEPTEMBER 2026

Grand Minangkabau Marandang & Culinary Festival

September 2026 | Jam Gadang Plaza Bukittinggi & Padang

The Grand Minangkabau Marandang & Culinary Festival is West Sumatra's foremost gastronomic celebration honoring Rendang's global acclaim as one of the world's most delicious dishes. Gathering hundreds of master village cooks, Bundo Kanduang matriarchs, and artisanal culinary producers from all 19 regencies and municipalities of West Sumatra, the festival showcases the simultaneous cooking of rendang over hundreds of open firewood hearths.

Throughout the event, the intoxicating aroma of caramelizing coconut milk and roasted spices envelops the city plaza, generating an exhilarating public celebration. Esteemed culinary judges evaluate the authenticity of traditional 'marandang' reduction techniques progressing from soupy gulai through thick kalio to the prized dark-brown caramelized finish.

Complementing the master cooking tournament, masterclasses demonstrate rare village recipes such as stuffed Nasi Kapau tambusu curries, wild eel rendang, Dadiah probiotic curd, and multi-layered Teh Talua egg tea. Travelers can savor authentic heritage rendang variations and purchase vacuum-sealed gourmet rendang directly from master artisans.



On Hiatus / Postponed (Planned Return in 2027)

Across West Sumatra Regencies & Cities

Tour de Singkarak (TdS) is a prestigious international road cycling race established in 2009, ingeniously designed to combine elite world-class sports competition with the celebration of West Sumatra's breathtaking landscapes and rich cultural heritage. Named after the iconic Lake Singkarak, the race is officially sanctioned under the UCI Asia Tour calendar.

The challenging race course winds across more than a dozen regencies and cities throughout West Sumatra, testing world-class cyclists against punishing mountain climbs along the Barisan Range, legendary hairpin curves like Kelok 44 and Kelok 9, and scenic coastal highways facing the Indian Ocean. Cheering local villagers line the roadsides en masse to greet peloton riders with traditional music and vibrant festivities.

Following a temporary hiatus during the global pandemic, Tour de Singkarak is currently being revitalized by regional and national authorities for a triumphant return in 2027, featuring a modernized sport tourism concept that emphasizes sustainability, eco-tourism, and direct economic empowerment for communities along the route.



JUMADA AL-THANI 1448 H / LATE 2026

Serak Gulo Padang Heritage Festival

📅 Jumada al-Thani 1448 H / Late 2026

📍 Muhammadan Mosque, Padang City

The Serak Gulo Padang Heritage Festival is a landmark annual multicultural gathering celebrating the historic showering of tons of sugar from the rooftop of the 1843 Muhammadan Mosque in Old Town Padang. Organized jointly by the Indian-descended Muslim community and native Minangkabau citizens, the festival shines as an enduring emblem of inter-ethnic harmony and religious tolerance in West Sumatra.

The morning begins with communal volunteers assembling thousands of small textile pouches filled with refined sugar. By late afternoon, thousands of spectators spanning diverse ethnicities and generations converge upon the boulevard fronting the mosque; to the thunder of celebratory drums, elders toss thousands of sweet parcels into the jubilant crowds below who reach out joyously to catch the symbolic blessings.

The festivities are enriched by bustling cross-cultural street food markets serving authentic Kubang Martabak, flaky roti canai with spiced mutton curry, aromatic biryani, alongside traditional rebana percussion performances. Serak Gulo stands as one of western Indonesia's most charismatic celebrations of multicultural heritage.



OCTOBER 29 – 31, 2026

Solok 5 Lakes Ecotourism Festival (KEN)

📅 October 29 – 31, 2026

📍 Solok Regency (5 Lakes: Singkarak, Diatas, Dibawah, Talang, Tuo)

Solok 5 Lakes Ecotourism Festival is an integrated nature, culture, and sports festival celebrating the unique geography of Solok Regency, home to the largest collection of natural volcanic lakes in West Sumatra. Featured in the prestigious Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) calendar, it spotlights five pristine lakes: Lake Singkarak, Lake Diatas, Lake Dibawah, Lake Talang, and Lake Tuo.

Festival events span multiple scenic lakeside venues, combining competitive dragon boat regattas, crater trekking excursions around Mount Talang, local cultural parades, and highland specialty Arabica coffee exhibitions from Alahan Panjang. Set against the crisp, cool 1,500-meter altitude climate of the Twin Lakes, open-air stages host energetic plate dancing and contemporary Minang musical compositions.

The festival serves as a vital platform for promoting lacustrine conservation and watershed protection while driving eco-tourism across Alahan Panjang's vast tea plantations and organic farms. The breathtaking lake vistas framed by pine-clad volcanic ridges make it an idyllic holiday haven for families and eco-travelers.

🏆 **KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):**
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



OCTOBER 1 – 3, 2026

Pesona Mentawai Indigenous Festival (KEN)

October 1 – 3, 2026 | Mentawai Islands (Siberut & Tuapejat)

Festival Pesona Mentawai is Indonesia's most authentic indigenous cultural gathering, celebrated across the pristine archipelago of the Mentawai Islands in the Indian Ocean. Endorsed by the national Karisma Event Nusantara (KEN) program, the festival is dedicated to honoring the ancestral wisdom, spirituality, and living megalithic heritage of the indigenous Mentawai people.

Visitors are granted rare firsthand access to sacred healing rituals performed by Sikerei (traditional shamans), mystical Turuk Laggai bird and animal dances, live demonstrations of the world's oldest hand-tapped tattooing tradition (Titi Mentawai), and bark-cloth apparel crafting (Baiko). On the coastline, the festivities are matched with high-octane surfing showcases on world-class barrel waves.

The festival opens a profound window into the ancient philosophy of Arat Sabulungan—the spiritual harmony between mankind and the living souls of nature. Combined with guided treks into Siberut's rainforest and tasting traditional smoked sago culinary delicacies, it provides an unparalleled anthropological journey of a lifetime.

KARISMA EVENT NUSANTARA (KEN):
Official national flagship event recognized by the Ministry of Tourism and Creative Economy (Kemenparekraf RI).



OCTOBER 2026

Air Bangis Coastal & Marine Festival

October 2026 | Air Bangis Port Bay, West Pasaman Regency

The Air Bangis Marine Festival is an annual coastal cultural celebration hosted at Air Bangis Port Bay, the northernmost maritime gateway of West Sumatra's western coastline. Air Bangis boasts a storied maritime history as one of Sumatra's oldest operational harbours, welcoming international merchant vessels since the Inderapura Sultanate and early VOC eras.

The festival dazzles with regattas of decorated traditional wooden sailing boats, coastal angling competitions, and dynamic seaside dance performances staged upon harbor piers against the backdrop of idyllic tropical islands like Pulau Panjang and Pulau Pigago. Crowds gather to revel in the untouched marine splendor of the open Indian Ocean.

Seafood enthusiasts are treated to grand public feasts featuring freshly grilled ocean fish and mangrove crabs caught by local artisanal fisherfolk, served with green chili sambal and calamansi limes. The Air Bangis Festival serves as a crucial springboard promoting undiscovered marine ecotourism across West Pasaman.



NOVEMBER 2026

Batang Arau Heritage & Padang Waterfront Festival

November 2026 | Old Town & Batang Arau Estuary, Padang City

The Batang Arau Heritage Festival is a captivating celebration of history, urban revitalization, and performing arts unfolding along the banks of the Batang Arau River in historic Old Town Padang. This district stands as a silent witness to 19th-century maritime trade where spice galleons berthed alongside monumental Dutch colonial trading houses and Indische Empire warehouses.

The festival lineup features vibrant illuminated dragon boat regattas on the river estuary, vintage and Minangkabau costume pageants across the Siti Nurbaya Bridge, evening floating lantern ceremonies, and exhibitions of colonial photographic archives. Heritage facades are bathed in architectural lighting, transforming the old harbor quarter into a breathtaking living museum.

Visitors savor nostalgic Old Town street foods ranging from spiced beef sate to Padang's legendary shaved durian desserts and Chinese-Minang culinary fusion snacks. The festival invites travelers to rediscover West Sumatra's glorious maritime legacy through vibrant contemporary cultural expressions.

TRAVEL GUIDE & ETIQUETTE

FESTIVAL VISITOR TIPS

Practical guide to experiencing Minangkabau cultural attractions safely and memorably.

1. Dress Code & Local Customs

Wear modest, polite, and culturally respectful attire. During sacred traditional ceremonies (Batagak Penghulu, Makan Bajamba), respect the solemn procession and follow the guidance of village elders/mamak.

2. Photography Tips for Pacu Jawi & Tabuik

Use a telephoto or zoom lens and protect your camera gear from mud splatters during Pacu Jawi. Always stay behind the marked safety line along the cattle racing course.

3. Accommodation & Transportation

Reserve hotel rooms or tourism village homestays well ahead of national KEN festival dates to ensure availability during peak visitor periods.

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